Chipunga Farms Limited (CFL) Child Protection Policy

1. Introduction

Chipunga Farms Limited (CFL) directors, staff, contractors and partners have a common commitment to prevention of child abuse and to the protection of children generally. This policy outlines related values, principles, and beliefs and describes the steps that will be taken to ensure that children are protected from all types of abuse in the execution of businesses and delivery of programs in all establishments under CFL.

2. Principles and Values

The following are the key principle, values and beliefs of CFL:

2.1. All children have equal rights to protection from abuse and exploitation.
2.2. Child abuse is never acceptable.
2.3. We have a commitment to protecting children for whom we, contractors and our partners care.
2.4. All our representatives, agents, contractors and partners have a responsibility to meet the minimum standards of protection for children in their programs and operations.
2.5. All concerns raised and especially accusations of abuse are to be taken seriously.

3. CFL Expectations of Agents, Contractors and Partners

The following are the expectation of directors, staff, agents, contractors and partners for CFL:

3.1. Directors, Staff , Agents, Contractors and Partners will ensure through awareness and good practice, that staff and others minimize the risks to children.
3.2. Every workplace will provide staff and the children under care with detailed instructions for reporting possible child abuse. These instructions should be posted in common areas.
3.3. Agents, Contractors and Partners will ensure that action is taken to support and protect children where concerns arise regarding possible abuse.
3.4. All partners educating and otherwise caring for children will agree to the terms of a Memorandum of Understanding with CFL that contains a Child Protection proviso and will

also make available to all their staff, contractors and volunteers the CFL's Child Protection Code of Conduct. The proviso is as follows:

> *"CFL has a deep concern for the wellbeing and safety of children. We are opposed to any form of child abuse and/or neglect and are committed to ensuring that no harm comes to children who participate in programs businesses and activities funded by our company. Similarly, because your agency receives support from CFL, you are expected to do everything within your power to mitigate the risk that children assisted by your program, business and activities are exposed to any form of child abuse or maltreatment. The World Health Organization (WHO) defines child abuse or maltreatment as: "all forms of physical and/or emotional ill-treatment, sexual abuse, neglect or negligent treatment or commercial or other exploitation, resulting in actual or potential harm to the child's health, survival, development or dignity in the context of a relationship of responsibility, trust or power (WHO, 1999)."*
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> *By signing this Memorandum of Understanding (MOU), you agree to demonstrate love and promote proper respect, wellbeing and dignity for all children, regardless of their race, gender, age, religion, disability, social background and culture."*

4. Chipunga Farms Limited Child Protection Code of Conduct

4.1.Don'ts

All staff, contractors and others in contact with children will never:

4.1.1. Hit or physically abuse children
4.1.2. Develop a physical or sexual relationship with children
4.1.3. Use language or behavior towards children that is inappropriate, abusive, sexually provocative, demeaning, or culturally inappropriate
4.1.4. Behave in a manner which is inappropriate or sexually provocative
4.1.5. Sleep in the same bed as a child for whom they are caring who is not a member of their immediate family.
4.1.6. Condone, or participate in behavior of children which is illegal, unsafe, or abusive
4.1.7. Hire children for domestic or other labor that is inappropriate given their age or developmental stage, especially when it interferes with their time available for education and recreational activities.

4.2.Dos

All staff and others in contact with children will:

4.2.1. Treat all children with respect regardless of race, color, gender, religion, or any other status

4.2.2. Be aware of and manage situations that may present risks.
4.2.3. Ensure that a culture of transparency exists in the workplace so that poor practice or abusive behavior does not go unchallenged.
4.2.4. Talk to children about their contact with staff or others and encourage them to raise their concerns with the appropriate adult authorities.
4.2.5. Teach children about their rights, what is acceptable and unacceptable, and what recourse they have if a problem arises.
4.2.6. Ensure that another adult is present whenever possible if children are in the vicinity.
4.2.7. Report to the Child Protection Focal Person in CFL or any relevant civil authority suspicion of child abuse of any form.
4.2.8. Shall always obtain informed consent from the child (where they are old enough and of sufficient mental health) and always also from a parent/guardian for children under 18 and vulnerable adults before any images or biographical information is used.

5. Reporting Cases of Child Abuse

5.1. If any agent of CFL develops a concern or suspicion regarding maltreatment of children or vulnerable adults of any kind – especially but not only by a fellow worker, whether in the same agency or not, they ***must*** report such concerns immediately to their Child Protection Focal Person in CFL or any relevant civil authority. No officer or staff member shall keep information regarding actual or suspected abuse private. To do so will be considered an act of gross misconduct.
5.2. The subject of any child or vulnerable adult abuse concern or complaint (alleged perpetrator) and all witnesses must cooperate fully and openly with internal and statutory investigations and hearings
5.3. Directors, staff and contractors of CFL must observe confidentiality and not talk about any situations of actual or suspected abuse that occurs except in accordance with this policy. This is necessary to protect the privacy of those involved.
5.4. Directors, staff and contractors of CFL who raises concerns of abuse of children and vulnerable adults will be protected as far as possible from victimization or any other detrimental treatment if concerns are raised in good faith. Deliberate false allegations will be taken seriously and will be investigated thoroughly.

6. Commitment Form for Child Protection

I ....., confirm that the Chipunga Farms Limited Child Protection Policy has been explained to me. I have had the opportunity to ask questions and to seek clarifications on points that were not clear to me.

I am fully aware of my obligations to act per the requirements of this Code of Conduct and the Safeguarding and Policy, including reporting instances of abuse or suspected abuse of children and vulnerable adults.

I understand the consequences and that I will take responsibility as an individual thereof if I fail to act on all matters contained in this policy.

Names (Capital Letters).....

Signature.....

Date.....

Witness
Names (Capital Letters).....

Signature.....

Date.....

-The End-